Jesse — May 21 Return Brief

Built: April 28, 2026 (updated April 29 — DOAC removed, pricing + IG arc added)

Author: Junior

For: Jesse to read first thing on May 21, before opening email

Purpose: You've been at sea for two weeks. This document gets you operational in 20 minutes.

The Situation in One Paragraph

Modern Savage is on track for July 1 but two critical unknowns — ship date and domain — are still unresolved. CJ owned the May 4 EBG call and your absence. The launch infrastructure is now complete: 5-email sequence, post-purchase flow (6 emails), Klaviyo spec, pricing recommendation, Bear IG arc, WhatsApp community, press brief, influencer seeding, podcast targets, kids blend, Calvin SOW draft. The decisions waiting for you in your first week back: pricing (before Stripe), influencer seeding (by May 23), podcast target (by May 26), Calvin SOW (by May 26). Read this first, then open email.

BEFORE YOU SAILED — Did These Happen? (ask CJ first)

Two things should have happened before or just after you sailed on May 7. CJ should have the answers.

Bear IG content arc approved? Ten posts across four phases were staged for your approval before May 7. Olly was supposed to execute Phase 1 (May 1-21) while you sailed. If you didn't approve before leaving, ask CJ/Olly: did Phase 1 happen? Brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-ig-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf. If Phase 1 didn't run, the launch audience isn't primed — factor this into the July 1 timing assessment.

Pricing set? The Stripe account cannot be configured without a price. Brief with recommendation at workspace/docs/modern-savage-pricing-analysis-2026-04-28.pdf. Recommended: £59/month adult regular, £47/month founding member (20% off, 12-month lock). If this wasn't agreed before sailing, Stripe isn't live — which means Email 1 hasn't sent and the 170-person waitlist is still waiting.

PART 1 — Verify What CJ Was Supposed to Do

Ask CJ for a verbal status on these five items before anything else.

1. Ship date from Lightning Nutra — MOST IMPORTANT

CJ was supposed to email Chris Liming (chris@lightningnutra.com) on April 29 to confirm the product ship date for all three SKUs. The question was: "Can you confirm the expected ship date for the SuperHero Add On order? We need product at our UK fulfillment partner by June 25."

Ask CJ: "Do we have a confirmed ship date? Is it before or after June 25?"

- Before June 25: good. Proceed.
- After June 25: launch moves. See contingency brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-manufacturing-contingency-2026-04-25.pdf.
- Still no answer: call Chris Liming yourself today. This is the single most important variable.

2. modernsavage.com — domain acquisition

CJ was managing a MediaOptions broker approach. Budget £2,000. Domain expires June 24 — a hard deadline.

Ask CJ: "Has MediaOptions made contact with the seller? What's the current status?"

If no progress by May 21: 34 days until expiry. Escalate urgently.

3. EBG May 4 call — what was decided

The May 4 Zoom happened while you were sailing. CJ should have a brief summary.

Ask CJ: "What was agreed and what was left open?" Key: did Bear commit to anything about the Creator Network or Modern Savage? Whatever Bear said is the reality you're managing from. Also: a new WhatsApp group (BG/JG/Del, April 22) revealed EBG is demanding 15% on ALL opportunities — not just Creator Network. This is new intelligence not in the May 4 prep brief. Brief at workspace/docs/ebg-new-intel-whatsapp-2026-04-28.pdf.

4. Twyn model from Zain

Zain Qazi was sending a revised Year 1/2/3 model the week of May 5. CJ was holding it for your return.

Ask CJ: "Has the Twyn model arrived? Can you forward it now?"

Reading guide at workspace/docs/twyn-financial-model-reading-guide-2026-04-25.pdf — read before opening the model.

5. Stripe + Ships A Lot Qwilr

Ask CJ: "Is the Stripe account live? Has the Ships A Lot Qwilr been signed?" Both were on the pre-sailing sprint. If Stripe isn't live, Email 1 hasn't gone out and the 170-person waitlist is still waiting.

PART 2 — Decisions Waiting for You (by deadline)

Immediate — Pricing (if not already set)

If pricing wasn't approved before sailing, this is Day 1. Stripe cannot be set up without it.

Recommendation: £59/month adult subscription, £47/month founding member (20% off, 12-month lock), £39/month kids, £89/month family bundle. Sits above Heart & Soil (~£44-52) and below AG1 (£79). Full rationale at workspace/docs/modern-savage-pricing-analysis-2026-04-28.pdf.

Critical: founding member price must NOT appear publicly until Email 4 (June 24). If it leaks before then, it anchors the public launch at the discount price.

By May 23 — Influencer Seeding List

Approve the 20-person target list. Ships A Lot needs to package and dispatch by June 1 for organic posts to land ahead of July 1.

Brief at workspace/docs/modern-savage-influencer-seeding-2026-04-28.pdf. What to do:

1. Read the brief (30 min)
2. Confirm or adjust top 5 targets
3. Personalise Bear's letter for Wim Hof and Ross Edgley specifically — these two warrant a personal note from Bear, not a template
4. Tell Calvin to execute

By May 26 — Podcast Target (replaced DOAC)

DOAC is off — Bear has already been on it. Two best alternatives: **Modern Wisdom** (Chris Williamson, 1M+ reach, perfect male 25-40 audience) and **Feel Better Live More** (Dr. Rangan Chatterjee, top UK health podcast). Pick one and make contact.

Full brief with booking approach, conflict checks, and framing for each at workspace/docs/modern-savage-podcast-targets-2026-04-28.pdf. If you have a personal line to Chris Williamson, a DM from Bear beats any booking form by a factor of ten.

By May 26 — Calvin Modern Savage SOW

The SOW draft is ready. Terms: $3,000/month from June 1, 2.5% equity at 5K subscribers + 2.5% at 10K. Three things to decide: start date (June 1 as drafted, or May 1 with £1,500 setup fee), equity percentages (2.5%+2.5% is what Calvin proposed — 1.5%+1.5% is more defensible for a part-time operator), and acquisition treatment of unvested equity.

Draft at workspace/docs/calvin-modern-savage-sow-draft-2026-04-28.pdf. Read it, mark your three decisions, send to Calvin. Do not give Calvin new paid work after May 26 without a signed agreement.

By May 28 — Twyn model response

After reviewing Zain's model: respond with direction. You don't need to accept or reject anything — just "we've reviewed, we have some questions, let's schedule a call for early June." Silence past May 28 risks them cooling off.

PART 3 — Status Reading (no decisions, just context)

Read these after handling Part 2.

EBG full picture — Two documents. First: workspace/docs/ebg-new-intel-whatsapp-2026-04-28.pdf (new April 28 — EBG's actual position is a 15% flat commission on all opportunities, not just Creator Network). Second: workspace/docs/may4-ebg-call-prep-2026-04-26.pdf (the Everest Fund production investment angle). Read both before your next conversation with Bear or Ben Simon.

Bear Instagram pre-launch arc — If Phase 1 didn't run while you were sailing, read workspace/docs/modern-savage-bear-ig-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf and assess what's salvageable. Phase 2 (May 22-June 14) still works even if Phase 1 is compressed. The Hint Post (Post 7, "I've been working on something for a while") should run before June 15.

Modern Savage launch infrastructure — All built. workspace/docs/modern-savage-launch-calendar-2026-04-28.pdf shows where everything should be as of May 21. Cross-check CJ's actual delivery against it. Also new since you left: WhatsApp Community strategy (workspace/docs/modern-savage-community-strategy-2026-04-28.pdf), Kids Blend brief (workspace/docs/modern-savage-kids-blend-brief-2026-04-29.pdf), Klaviyo setup spec (workspace/docs/modern-savage-klaviyo-setup-spec-2026-04-28.pdf).

LFG Outdoors Network — Source Media Group (Owen Leimbach) pitched CJ/Del: co-own an outdoor YouTube network with Bear, same model as their Source Golf launch (Bryson DeChambeau, Grant Horvat). First year costs: "very low 7 figures." Key unanswered question: is Bear expected to write a capital check or just contribute brand and content? Don't let CJ commit to anything without knowing the answer. Brief at workspace/docs/lfg-outdoors-network-brief-2026-04-28.pdf.

Henri-Lloyd — You should have offshore content from the Arctic leg. Contact Emilia Renshaw (emilia.renshaw@henrilloyd.com) when back. The February Heads of Agreement included an expedition content angle — HL is expecting it.

PART 4 — The Non-Modern-Savage Stack

Item	Status	What to do
Tattarang (Taki Dermedgoglou)	CJ following up from Bear's April 23 intro	Check if there's been a reply. Brief at workspace/docs/wildernests-tattarang-diligence-2026-04-25.pdf
Alfred pitch	May 5 coffee with Tom Inskip and Alice happened before sailing	Ask CJ what the outcome was
Rick Landman callback	+447624277888 — 30-second bank verification	Was flagged urgent. Check if resolved.

Item	Status	What to do
BPS Hub (Sam Cotton)	leasing@bpsdc.co.uk	Check if CJ moved forward
Becoming X resignation	Bear's formal resignation was due by May 6	Confirm it's done
Sister Swims trademark	UK00004372256 — opposition window ~June 24	No action needed, awareness only

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The 5-Question Verbal Debrief with CJ (do this before reading email)

1. Ship date from Lightning Nutra — confirmed or not?
2. Domain acquisition — where are we with MediaOptions?
3. EBG May 4 call — what was agreed? Did Bear commit to anything?
4. Has Twyn's model arrived?
5. Is Stripe live? Was Ships A Lot Qwilr signed?

If all five have clean answers, you're in good shape. If any are red — start there.

Built April 28, 2026 by Junior. Updated April 29: DOAC removed (Bear already done it), pricing decision added, Bear IG arc added as pre-sailing requirement, EBG 15% flat demand intel added, Calvin SOW draft flagged as ready. Jesse reads May 21. Ship date and domain are the two live blockers — everything else is manageable.